

# Average Payoff, Typical Ticket

Unit 2 · Topic 2.8 · TODAY'S PROBLEM

Suppose a club sells 200 raffle tickets for \$2 each. One ticket wins \$100, four tickets win \$25 each, 20 tickets win \$5 each, and the other tickets win nothing. Let  $X$  be the buyer's net profit from one randomly chosen ticket: prize minus ticket cost.

**Priya:** *The average gross payout is \$1.50 per ticket, so buying one is a good deal.*

**Mateo:** *Most tickets win nothing.*

**Ticket net-profit distribution**

| Prize        | Net $x$ | $P(X = x)$ |
|--------------|---------|------------|
| Top prize    | 98      | 1/200      |
| Second prize | 23      | 4/200      |
| Small prize  | 3       | 20/200     |
| No prize     | -2      | 175/200    |

## FIRST TAKE (5 min, on your sheet)

Would you buy one ticket if your goal were to make money? Use one number or outcome from the problem.

- DOK 1** (a) State the four possible values of  $X$  and identify the most likely value.
- DOK 2** (b) Verify that the probabilities form a distribution. Calculate the expected gross payout and the expected net profit  $\mu_X$ .
- DOK 3** (c) Decide whether Priya's numerical statement and Mateo's statement can both be true, and explain why there is no contradiction. Assess Priya's good-deal conclusion using the ticket cost and  $\mu_X$ . Explain what expected value does and does not predict for one buyer, then decide whether you would buy and defend the criterion behind your choice.

**Video + follow-along:** [u4\\_lesson7-8\\_live.html](https://www.khanacademy.org/a/u4_lesson7-8_live.html) (scan the code)

Finish (a)–(c) after the video. Turn in your sheet.

